Later Pandyas

The contribution of Later Pandyas to South Indian art was significant. A case in point is the cave temple at Pillayarpatti (near Karaikudi, TamilNadu) belonging to 13th century. This temple is important both for its sculptures and for an inscription. A beautiful Ganesha is carved facing the entrance. The importance of the figure, referred to *Desivinayaga* in the cave inscription, is that there are two arms with the trunk turning to the right



Pillayarpatti Temple and
Karpaka Vinayagar

Vijayanagara Epoch

During the Vijayanagara epoch, a new form of construction emerged. It is the *mandapam* (pavilion) to where the gods are carried every year. Pillared outdoor *mandapams* are meant for public rituals with the ones in the east serving as the waiting room for devotees, which adorn the large temples. These *mandapams* attract attention for its monolithic pillars. On these pillars are sculptured horses, lions and the gods. The kalyana mandapam at Kanchipuram (Varadaraja Perumal temple) and at Vellore (Jalagandeshwar temple) are notable examples. The most celebrated of these *mandapams* in temple of Madurai is the Pudumandapam.



Vellore Jalagandeshwar Temple
Kalyana Mandapam

The main features of the Vijayanagar and Nayak architecture are decorated mandapas, ornamental pillars, life-size images, gopuras, prakaras, music pillars, floral works and stone windows during the 15th to 17th centuries. Tanks are attached to the temples. Gateways to temple are constructed from four directions with massive *gopurams*.

The practice of fitting the niches with sculptures continued during the Nayak period. There was an increased use of major sculpted figures (relief sculpture) as found at the Alakiya Nambi temple at Tirukkurungudi (Tirunelveli district) and the Gopalakrishna temple in the Ranganatha temple complex at Srirangam. The southern festival mandapam of Adinatha temple at Azhwar Tirunagari and the porch of the Nellaiyappar temple at Tirunelveli are other notable examples.



Mandapam of Adinatha Temple,
Azhwar Tirunagari